

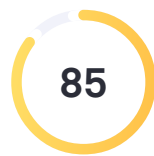
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by Daniyal Ahmed

General metrics

7,232	1,132	57	4 min 31 sec	8 min 42 sec
characters	words	sentences	reading time	speaking time

Score



Writing Issues

47	18	29
Issues left	Critical	Advanced

This text scores better than 85% of all texts checked by Grammarly

Writing Issues

19	Correctness	
1	Wrong or missing prepositions	
4	Determiner use (a/an/the/this, etc.)	
8	Incorrect punctuation	
2	Misspelled words	
1	Closing punctuation	
1	Faulty subject-verb agreement	
2	Comma misuse within clauses	

Unique Words

Measures vocabulary diversity by calculating the percentage of words used only once in your document

45%

unique words

Rare Words

Measures depth of vocabulary by identifying words that are not among the 5,000 most common English words.

35%

rare words

Word Length

Measures average word length

5.1

characters per word

Sentence Length

Measures average sentence length

19.9

words per sentence

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Academic Institution

Reflection Paper

Purpose Statement

By

Name

Location

Date

Reflection Paper

Being accepted ¹in ²seminary is a great milestone- an occurrence that implies dedication to studies and spiritual maturity. To help us wade through the challenges that come along with theological education, Daniel Zacharias and Benjamin K. Forrest ³in ⁴their book Surviving and Thriving in Seminary: An Academic and Spiritual Handbook ⁵have provided a guide that will help anyone going through theological education¹. It would be a misanthropy to describe the book as a guide to academic success; the book rather, ⁶is the spiritual guide that is set to assist seminarians in excelling in their hearts and minds. The text was extremely inspiring and convenient to me, as a student, though just starting the transformative process, the text brought to light ⁷correct attributes and attitudes necessary to achieve the process of personal and spiritual transformation.

One of the thematic points that is commendable in Zacharias and Forrest is the need to realign those expectations at the seminary ⁸

Benjamin K. Forrest and H. Daniel Zacharias, Surviving and Thriving in Seminary: An Academic and Spiritual Handbook (Bellingham, WA: Lexham Press, 2017), 3.

2 Ibid., 5.

3 Ibid., 27.

4 Ibid., 31.

. Most individuals ⁹being ¹⁰undergraduates come into graduate-level theological education bringing with them certain assumptions based upon previous educational experience; all the same, the authors ¹¹cautions that this should not be extrapolated into seminary unrefined². The seminary research is not like the traditional other graduate programs, which involve only intellectual studies to

be carried on, but in this ¹²case it requires much more than ¹³this, it also needs deep spiritual resistance and emotional wellness.

The part about the spiritual disciplines is one of the most resonant ones in the text. The authors believe that one should take the importance of praying, reading the Scripture, and resting during the Sabbath, even though there may be some stiff academic duties ahead of them¹⁴₃. According to them, no theological training can ever replace the starved soul⁴. This principle works well with Psalm 1:2-3, as we are offered the image of the blessed man/woman, who has their delight in the law of the Lord, whose testimony was that he was like a tree planted by the water sides⁵. The picture brings out the life-giving advantage of the continued contact with God. The chapter, in turn, challenged me to realize that devotional time is essential and not optional to my success in seminary.

The work at hand by Zacharias and Forrest considers the academic and psychological sides of health. Among its main contributions, one can cite its methodological treatment of practical approaches to time management. Long-range plans, time-blocking, and clear goals of ensuring balance, according to the authors, are such critical tools that keep a person on track

6 The Holy Bible, English Standard Version (Wheaton, IL: Crossway Bibles, 2016), Ps. 1:23.

7 Forrest and Zacharias, *Surviving and Thriving in Seminary*, 42.

8 *Ibid.*, 43.

6. Not the least important is the idea of creating a semester-at-a-glance calendar, which would include all assignment due dates, as well as post family responsibilities and rest time⁷. This integrated system has not only aided the academic performance but also prevented the risk. The author had experienced

overcommitment previously, ¹⁵ and, this advice helped tremendously; later on, the same practices should be applied to continue to work productively and stay connected to spirituality.

The third sphere that is central to the seminary education is community and relationship networks. The authors dispel the common myth that solitude is the quintessence of serious scholarship and emphasize the need to have friendship and accountability to each other⁸. They note that the long-term isolation creates emotional exhaustion and spiritual susceptibility, a state of being particularly relevant in the seminary context where the students might be inclined to portray an appearance of spiritual maturity. Representing the Proverbs 27:17 that goes, "Iron sharpens iron, and one man sharpens another" the literature affirms that the process of building an authentic relationship is indeed not just a satisfaction to the self; the point bought the author to place an emphasis on working with fellow peers in the form of supporting, encouraging others; and also praying with them, as a healthy growth is very commonly achieved in group settings⁹

9 The Holy Bible, ESV, Prov. 27:17.

10 Forrest and Zacharias, Surviving and Thriving in Seminary, 58.

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Analyzing the text, the scholars can notice that the authors show accurate precision and intellectual candor in their approach to the mental health problems. They specifically warn against diminishing the emotional aspects of ministry and note that uncontrolled worry and stress not only affect personal health, but also the effectiveness of the Christian service¹⁰. Their suggestion of a position between both poles, which does not spiritualise emotional diseases so that it annihilates the possibility of their occurrence, sounds quite

commendable. The encouragement of students to get counselling once the need takes shape, further accompanied by being taught on ways to take care of themselves and check their emotional health accordingly, thus seems rational and theologically shrewd. The reminder is particularly relevant in the context of modern church leadership, where the rates of occupational burnout are rather high, and the phenomenon is partly associated with the lack of properly established emotional boundaries.

The unique and outstanding thing about this work comes in the ability to combine strategic, practical advice with superior spiritual wisdom. Instead of viewing the study in the seminary as an academic hurdle against which they need to prevail, the authors treat it rather as a character-shaping anvil on which they are smithing their characters and callings. They assert that acquiring information is not the direct objective of seminary study, but the direct goal of making oneself Christlike, and that goal is, in its turn, in line with the teaching offered by the Apostle Paul in 2 Timothy 2: 15: "Do your best to present yourself to God as one approved, a worker who has no need to be ashamed." The fact that they characterize seminary¹⁶ as a formational enterprise that, at the same time, is committed to the educational ideal of scholastic excellence has reshaped the way I approach my academic pursuits.

As shown by the volume entitled *Surviving and Thriving in Seminary*, presented by Zacharias and Forrest, the title of the book is not an exaggeration. The authors create an intentional and comprehensive guideline that aims to assist students in sailing through the seminaries with competence and spiritual maturity. Their advice is common sense and literal Scripture-based and¹⁷ given in a very pastoral tone. Imperatively, the book serves as a reminder to me that seminary¹⁸ should not be viewed and treated as a stepping stone to the field of ministry, but as a divine place of change, development and¹⁹ obedience.

1.	in → into	Wrong or missing prepositions	Correctness
2.	a seminary	Determiner use (a/an/the/this, etc.)	Correctness
3.	, in	Incorrect punctuation	Correctness
4.	Handbook,	Incorrect punctuation	Correctness
5.	education1 → education	Misspelled words	Correctness
6.	, rather	Incorrect punctuation	Correctness
7.	the correct	Determiner use (a/an/the/this, etc.)	Correctness
8.	seminary.	Closing punctuation	Correctness
9.	, being	Incorrect punctuation	Correctness
10.	undergraduates,	Incorrect punctuation	Correctness
11.	eautione → caution	Faulty subject-verb agreement	Correctness
12.	case,	Comma misuse within clauses	Correctness
13.	this, → this;	Incorrect punctuation	Correctness
14.	them3 → them	Misspelled words	Correctness
15.	and,	Incorrect punctuation	Correctness
16.	the seminary	Determiner use (a/an/the/this, etc.)	Correctness
17.	, and	Incorrect punctuation	Correctness
18.	the seminary	Determiner use (a/an/the/this, etc.)	Correctness
19.	, and	Comma misuse within clauses	Correctness